centric operation as Op-1, and the one which started after January 1980 and ended with Operation Blue Star in June 1984 as Op-2.

As Op-2 progressed, the bitter pill of falsehood had to be repeatedly sugar-coated by its creators before it could be administered in the form of Operation Blue Star to a large number of 'suffering' potential voters to relieve them of their 'fear', 'apprehension', 'pain', 'mental agony' and 'hatred', and earn their gratitude and their votes.

The characters running Op-1 have already been mentioned above. For Op-2, after January 1980, Makhan Lal Fotedar, political assistant to Prime Minister Gandhi, Arun Nehru, Sanjay's cousin and MP from Rae Bareli, and later Arun Singh from the Kapurthala family were added to this group. After Sanjay's death in June 1980, his elder brother Rajiv Gandhi took his place. Sanjay was the main driving force behind Op- 2. After his death, Rajiv depended heavily on Arun Nehru, M.L. Fotedar and Arun Singh, even much after his mother's assassination on 31 October 1984.

As all the decisions pertaining to Op- 2 were taken at 1 Akbar Road, '1 Akbar Road group' has been used in the book to refer to those responsible for certain actions taken in connection with Op 2. Further, during that period, decisions in the various ministries at the Centre and in the Punjab government that had a bearing on Op-2 was informally taken over by the 1 Akbar Road group or the senior bureaucrats working with them. Besides running various errands, Arun Nehru and Arun Singh were also attending meetings either alone or along with Rajiv Gandhi. Two such meetings have been mentioned in Chapter 9.



In view of the developments mentioned above, while performing a small role in furtherance of the main purpose of that operation, I initially felt I was doing what was routine work for a member of a pliant intelligence agency to help its mentor score brownie points against political rivals. However, I had successive opportunities to look at the bare bones of the wrapped skeleton, and soon developed a feeling that I was being used, in howsoever limited a manner, to